

Nicholas Morse

Curriculum Vitae

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📍 Stockholm, Sweden
👤 Citizenship: USA

Researcher with expertise in large-eddy simulation (LES) and direct numerical simulation (DNS) of turbulent boundary layers, jets, and multiphase flows.

Education

- 2023 **PhD**, *Aerospace Engineering & Mechanics*, University of Minnesota
Thesis: “High-fidelity unstructured overset simulation of complex turbulent flows” [↗](#)
Adviser: Professor Krishnan Mahesh
- 2020 **MS**, *Aerospace Engineering & Mechanics*, University of Minnesota
- 2018 **BAEM**, *Aerospace Engineering & Mechanics*, University of Minnesota
Minors: Math, Astrophysics

Skills

<i>Coding</i>	Fortran, Python, Matlab, Bash, Git	<i>CFD</i>	Neko, MPCUGLES, OpenFOAM, ANSYS, Basilisk
<i>HPC</i>	MPI, Make, CMake	<i>Meshing</i>	GridPro, Pointwise, Salome, Gmsh
<i>Visualization</i>	ParaView, Tecplot, VisIt, PyVista	<i>Engineering</i>	SolidWorks, Simulink

Experience

- May 2025 – Present **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *KTH Royal Institute of Technology*, Stockholm, Sweden
FLOW (Professors Philipp Schlatter, Ramis Örlü, and Mihai Mihaescu)
 - Performed >10 billion point DNS of a 3D turbulent boundary layer on Europe's first exascale computer (JUPITER) with the GPU-accelerated spectral element solver *Neko* [↗](#).
 - Developed a module in *Neko* for computation of scalar variance and turbulent scalar flux budgets.
 - Taught and developed exercises for a graduate-level turbulence course.
- Jan – May 2025 **Group Leader: Multiscale CFD**, *Research Center Pharmaceutical Engineering*, Graz, Austria
- 2023 – 2025 **Senior Scientist**, *Research Center Pharmaceutical Engineering*, Graz, Austria
 - Led the simulation strategy development for an EU Horizon 2020 project.
 - Coded a boundary element method from the ground up to resolve sub-Kolmogorov droplet breakup.
 - Unstructured curved elements, Gauss–Legendre quadrature, adaptive mesh refinement, feature-preserving mesh smoothing, adaptive time stepping, matrix-free GMRES(k), fast multipole method.
 - Implemented an ethanol-water mixture model in OpenFOAM to simulate impingement jet mixing.
- 2018 – 2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Minnesota*, Minneapolis, MN, USA
Computational Fluids Lab (Professor Krishnan Mahesh)
 - Performed large-scale (~10000 processor) simulations of complex turbulent flows using HPC.
 - Formulated streamline coordinates to study curvature in axisymmetric turbulent boundary layers.
 - Resolved experimental trip wires in LES to analyze model-scale boundary layer memory effects.
 - Identified mixing-enhancing secondary vortices from DNS and DMD of a jet in crossflow.
 - Extended a massively-parallel in-house unstructured finite-volume overset LES/DNS code.
 - Implemented *Hypre* GPU solvers, viscous flux corrections, and overset grid cutting algorithms.
- 2016 – 2017 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, *University of Minnesota*, Minneapolis, MN, USA
Turbulent Shear Flow Lab (Professor Ellen Longmire)
 - Designed tunable-buoyancy spheres to study particle transport in a turbulent boundary layer.
 - Manufactured and set up equipment for particle image velocimetry (PIV) experiments.
 - Measured the Stokes number dependence of particle restitution coefficients using high-speed imaging.

Service

Co-organizer and session chair of a workshop at the *Banff International Research Station*: “Particulates across Scales: Mathematical Modeling, Computation, and Applications” [↗](#)

Reviewer for the *Journal of Fluid Mechanics* and *International Journal of Heat and Fluid Flow*.

Teaching & Mentorship

Led wind tunnel labs for laminar/turbulent boundary layer theory and developed and taught recitation exercises for a graduate-level turbulence course.

Mentorship of undergraduate students in overset DNS, Tecplot, and GridPro to simulate freely rising/falling particles in six-degree-of-freedom motion.

Publications

Journal articles

N. Morse. Insights into sub-Kolmogorov-scale droplet breakup via boundary element simulations [↗](#). *International Journal of Multiphase Flow*, 105460, 2025.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. Tripping effects on model-scale studies of flow over the DARPA SUBOFF [↗](#). *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, 975:A3, 2023.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. Effect of tabs on the shear layer dynamics of a jet in cross-flow [↗](#). *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, 958:A6, 2023.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. Large-eddy simulation and streamline coordinate analysis of flow over an axisymmetric hull [↗](#). *Journal of Fluid Mechanics*, 926:A18, 2021.

Conference papers & abstracts

N. Morse, N. Jansson, M. Bode, R.J. Lingwood, P.H. Alfredsson, M. Mihaescu, R. Örlü, and P. Schlatter. Direct numerical simulation of the rotating disk turbulent boundary layer. *14th International Symposium on Turbulence and Shear Flow Phenomena (TSFP14)*, 2026.

N. Morse, R. Stanly, R. Örlü, and P. Schlatter. Streamline curvature and crossflow effects on the turbulent boundary layer over a Gaussian bump. *14th International Symposium on Turbulence and Shear Flow Phenomena (TSFP14)*, 2026.

N. Morse, M. Bode, N. Jansson, M. Mihaescu, R. Örlü, and P. Schlatter. Direct numerical simulation of the turbulent boundary layer on a rotating disk [↗](#). *15th ERCOFTAC Workshop on Direct and Large Eddy Simulation (DLES15)*, 2026.

N. Morse. Insights into sub-Kolmogorov droplet breakup via a boundary element method [↗](#). *BIRS Workshop: Particulates across Scales: Mathematical Modeling, Computation, and Applications*, 2025.

N. Morse, J. Remmelgas, and J. Khinast. A simulation framework for nanodroplet breakup in top-down nanoparticle production [↗](#). *AIChE Annual Meeting*, 2024.

M. Fenelon, Y. Zhang, L. Cattafesta, **N. Morse**, K. Mahesh, L. Li, and Z. Pan. Optimized timing schemes for multi-pulse shake-the-box particle tracking velocimetry [↗](#). *AIAA SciTech Forum*, 2023.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. The shear layer structure of a tabbed jet in crossflow [↗](#). *75th Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2022.

M. Fenelon, L. Cattafesta, Y. Zhang, K. Mahesh, and **N. Morse**. Optimizing dt for MP-STB in particle tracking velocimetry [↗](#). *75th Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2022.

N. Morse, T. Kroll, and K. Mahesh. Large-eddy simulation of submerged marine vehicles [↗](#). *Proceedings of the 34th Symposium on Naval Hydrodynamics, Washington, DC*, 2022.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. Streamline coordinate analysis of the flow past an axisymmetric body computed by large-eddy simulation [↗](#). *74th Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2021.

N. Morse and K. Mahesh. Large-eddy simulation of appended submerged vehicles using an unstructured overset grid method [↗](#). *73rd Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2020.

T. Kroll, **N. Morse**, W. Horne, and K. Mahesh. Large eddy simulation of marine flows over complex geometries using a massively parallel unstructured overset method [↗](#). *Proceedings of the 33rd Symposium on Naval Hydrodynamics, Osaka, Japan*, 2020.

N. Morse, W. Horne, and K. Mahesh. Towards large-eddy simulation of maneuvering vehicles using an unstructured overset grid method [↗](#). *72nd Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2019.

D. Barros, Y. H. Tee, **N. Morse**, B. Hiltbrand, and E. Longmire. Investigation of particle lift off in a turbulent boundary layer [↗](#). *70th Annual Meeting of the APS DFD*, 2017.

Awards

- 2026 Best Video, Swedish E-Science Research Centre (SeRC) Annual Meeting
- 2026 Erik Petersohns Memorial Foundation Grant
- 2026 Semi-finalist, ERCOFTAC Milton Van Dyke Visualization Competition
- 2019 John A. & Jane Dunning Copper Fellowship for Aerospace Engineering & Mechanics
- 2018 Donald & Shirley Gorence Scholarship
- 2017 Robert H. & Marjorie F. Jewitt Fund Scholarship

Interests

Mountain biking, road cycling, skiing, running, hiking, tennis, bouldering